



NAVAL GUNS

Although most artillery pieces were muzzle-loading by the 18th century, some naval guns continued to be breech-loading. In naval warfare, different types of gun could be useful in different situations, so special pieces of artillery were developed. For longer ranges, conventional cannon were used, mounted on carriages with wooden wheels, or “trucks,” while for close-in attacks, a short-barreled type of gun called a carronade was very effective. Sometimes known as the “smasher,” the carronade was built in different sizes and could fire solid shot or explosive shells with great power, although it did not have great range. Mortars could be used to attack ships, but were more often used to shell defenses or troops on shore.

► **FOUR-POUNDER SWIVEL GUN**

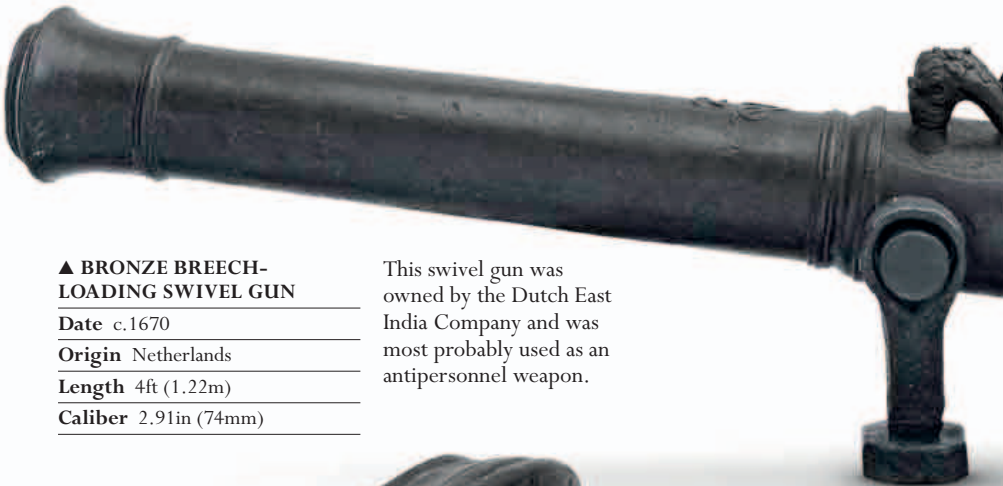
Date	1778
Origin	Scotland
Length	1ft (0.32m)
Caliber	3.30in (84mm)

This short, heavy swivel gun was one of the prototypes for the carronade made by the Carron Ironworks. Its trunnions—used to elevate and lower the gun—are equipped with pivots, and the cascabel—is used to secure the gun against recoil—is connected to a long, curved tiller for directing the gun.

▼ **BRITISH 13-IN MORTAR**

Date	1726
Origin	England
Length	5½ft (1.6m)
Caliber	13in (330mm)

The reinforce ring of this sea service mortar shows the royal arms of the British king George II. The mortar may have been made for HMS *Thunder*, which saw action at the Siege of Gibraltar in 1727.



▲ **BRONZE BREECH-LOADING SWIVEL GUN**

Date	c.1670
Origin	Netherlands
Length	4ft (1.22m)
Caliber	2.91in (74mm)

This swivel gun was owned by the Dutch East India Company and was most probably used as an antipersonnel weapon.



Reinforce ring

Muzzle

Carrying handles

Replacement bed for land service, 8½ft (2.64m) long

Reinforce ring

Trunnion inscription reads “Carron 1778”

